

THE WEIRD AL STYLEBOOK

A Mostly Serious Guide to Writing Good and Stuff

Inspired by Weird Al Yankovic and the song "*Word Crimes*"

"Grammar exists to improve communication, not to help strangers feel superior online."

FOREWORD

The AP Stylebook tells you how to write for newspapers. The Weird AI Stylebook tells you how to avoid being mocked in a four-minute pop parody. This guide follows the spirit of “Word Crimes”: a mix of legitimate grammar advice, exaggerated pedantry, and theatrical disappointment in humanity.

APOSTROPHES

It's means *it is*. **Its** is possessive. If you misuse apostrophes, the internet will judge you silently and forever.

LESS VS. FEWER

Use **fewer** for things you can count and **less** for things you cannot. No grocery store sign has ever obeyed this rule.

YOUR VS. YOU'RE

Your indicates possession. **You're** means *you are*. If replacing the word with “you are” sounds ridiculous, use **your**.

LITERALLY

Use **literally** when something actually happened in physical reality. If you literally died laughing, please stop emailing.

OXFORD COMMA

Use the Oxford comma whenever clarity matters. Without it, your parents might accidentally become Weird AI and coffee.

ALL CAPS

Typing in all caps makes your sentence sound like it was written during a kitchen fire. Use sparingly.

EMAIL ETIQUETTE

Subject lines should explain reality, contain verbs, and avoid mystery. A subject line of “Hey” is not useful to anyone.

FINAL PRINCIPLES

Good writing should be clear, concise, human, and readable. Proofread your emails. Use apostrophes responsibly. And never write “for all intensive purposes.”

THE WEIRD AL SEVERITY SCALE

LEVEL	DESCRIPTION
1	Minor typo
2	Misused apostrophe
3	“Your an idiot”
4	Comic Sans résumé
5	Reply-all catastrophe
6	Inspirational quote in Papyrus
7	“Should of” in a professional email
8	Entire LinkedIn post in ALL CAPS
9	Live tweeting a funeral
10	“Could care less” tattoo

Inspired by the AP Stylebook and the educational chaos of Weird Al Yankovic’s “Word Crimes.”